POL 93

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have reached the billions of 88.–a. From the telli- veyor of Captain Choyer, who gave anders to certain queries drawn up by Mr Dalymple concerning the po- utes first appears to be lead when in the latitude of 83". One Mr Watt informed our author, then when he was 7 years of age, as that time making his first voyage on Captain M McCallon, a le hold an fullina n- vigor, who commanded a Scotch whale-fishing dip, as during the time that the whales are fupped to copia the so fishing one, the carried on, the captain evolved to employ that interIn in attempting to resta the north pole. He ascondingly revealed because the lead ob- duction on 88; when the fea was not only open to the northwest, but they had now no ice on the last three degrees, but which he fill advanced, the ante complained that, the compils was not Ready, and the Captain was often dealt with collection to give over his attempts TD Compell, the combination of Harriss voyages, informed Mr Harrington, that Dr Jitalie, an- vivord Mullan, being in his work on board. In March July of, or which at that time was ufully feat to fu- penined the Greenland fishery, the captain determined, like the toocimshn above mentioned, to make an attempt to reach the pole during the intervent leaves the drift too forest fisheries. He expressed, according to the belt di Dr Campbell's recollection, as far as 88'3 when the weelwe was warm, the for free from ice, and falling like the bay of Bicky. Zullies now prefilled the expense to proceed:) but he answered, that he had already gone to for, and finally the himself it Holland has regarding his history upon which account he would differ on journal to the kept, but returned is soon as probable to Philology as the year (66-20), Mr Dobberg, than fercerty of the Royal Society, was ordered to regite a paper, entitled " Several linguists concerning Greenland, minnows by Mr Gary, who had visited their posts." The 19th of their queries is the following: If we were hath any one been known to approach the plot? The name is, I once met upon the coult of Greatlanda Holderar that force me had been half a degree from the days, though one are his journal, which was sila attested by his mares, where they had ten an ice on day, but ali winter Go. In Captain Woodss ac- count of a voyage its quell of the north-ent pulgage, we have the following account of a Dutch high which ended the mistake the 69/o". Captain Condekly, who had made above 30 voyages to Greenland, did relate to his majdly, the being a Greatland form 30 years before, he was at company with two Filhamalians to the ealiward of Edges lineal and that the whales are ap- peemings on the shore, the Hindians were determined to be further encountered I and in a fortnights time return- ed, and gave it out that they had failed into the life- undys of, and that they did not meet him any face, but a free and open teas, and that there aren a very bullazing groups fail. Next, the job Bicky, Mr Gould, we bring not finished with the bare relation, they pro-duced him four journals of the two ships, which fulfilled them, none, that they agreed them four instances."–7. In the Philadelphia Traffletions for 167; we knew the following pulgage: ńFor it is well known to all that fish northward, instead of the north-ern coasts are frozen up for many fingers, though in the open fea it is not by no more under the pole right, unless by accident!" In which pulgage, we have the following requestout of 2 Dutch high which could see the ultimate of 69/o". Captain Thomas Robertson offand our author, that he had been in latitude 834, that the fea real open, and he was certain that he could

Ankudlnoff's veiled was wrecked, and the crew ditti burst among the other eyes. Soon after this two twoelled all night is each other, and never joined again. Dishheff was driven about by competition winds till Quizley, who was shipwrecks confidently in the fourth of the Analyry. Having at fall reached that ri- were, he found a lotumely by the fama way that she had come, but never made the attempt. As for Alexeeff, after being allo fluyeerekek, he said died of all six furry, together with Ankudloods part of the crew were killed by the changes, and a few escaped to Kamilichak, where no ferled.

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Pole. Ankudinoff's veſſel was wrecked, and the crew diſtributed among the other two. Soon after this the two veſſels loſt ſight of each other, and never joined again. Deſhneff was driven about by tempeſtuous winds till October, when he was ſhipwrecked conſiderably to the ſouth of the Anadyr. Having at laſt reached that river, he formed a ſcheme of returning by the ſame way that he had come, but never made the attempt. As for Alexeeff, after being alſo ſhipwrecked, he had died of the ſcurvy, together with Ankudinoff; part of the crew were killed by the ſavages, and a few eſcaped to Kamſchatka, where they ſettled."

* See Cook's *Diſcoveries*, n° 95.—100. From Captain * Cook's voyage towards the north-eaſtern parts of Aſia, it appears that it is poſſible to double the promontory of Tſchutſki without any great difficulty: and it now appears, that the continents of Aſia and America are ſeparated from one another but by a narrow ſtrait, which is free from ice; but, to the northwards, that experienced navigator was everywhere ſtopped by the ice in the month of Auguſt, ſo that he could neither trace the American continent farther than to the latitude of 70°, nor reach the mouth of the river Kovyma on the Aſiatic continent; though it is probable that this might have been done at another time, when the ſituation of the ice was altered either by winds or currents.

12 Inſurmountable obſtacles in the north-eaſt paſſage. On the whole, therefore, it appears that the inſurmountable obſtacle in the north-eaſt paſſage lies between the rivers Piaſida and Chatanga; and unleſs there be in that ſpace a connection between the Aſiatic and American continents, there is not in any other part. Ice, however, is as effectual an obſtruction as land: and though the voyage were to be made by accident for once, it never could be eſteemed a paſſage calculated for the purpoſes of trade, or any other beneficial purpoſe whatever.

13 Of the north-weſt paſſage. With regard to the north-weſt paſſage, the ſame difficulties occur as in the other. Captain Cook's voyage has now aſſured us, that if there is any ſtrait which divides the continent of America into two, it muſt lie in a higher latitude than 70°, and conſequently be perpetually frozen up. If a north-weſt paſſage can be found then, it muſt be by ſailing round the whole American continent, inſtead of ſeeking a paſſage through it, which ſome have ſuppoſed to exiſt at the bottom of Baffin's bay. But the extent of the American continent to the northward is yet unknown; and there is a poſſibility of its being joined to that part of Aſia between the Piaſida and Chatanga, which has never yet been circumnavigated*. It remains therefore to conſider, whether there is any poſſibility of attaining the wiſhed-for paſſage by ſailing directly north, between the eaſtern and weſtern continents.

* See Cook's *Diſcoveries*, n° 12.

13 Barrington's arguments in favour of a poſſibility of reaching the pole. Of the practicability of this method, the Honourable Daines Barrington is very confident, as appears by ſeveral tracts which he publiſhed in the years 1775 and 1776, in conſequence of the unſucceſsful attempts made by Captain Phipps, now Lord Mulgrave. See *North-Eaſt Paſſage*.—In the tracts now alluded to he inſtances a great number of navigators who have reached very high northern latitudes; nay, ſome who have been at the pole itſelf, or gone beyond it.—Theſe inſtances are, 1. One Captain Thomas Robertſon aſſured our author, that he had been in latitude 82½, that the ſea was open, and he was certain that he could have reached the latitude of 83°.—2. From the teſtimony of Captain Cheyne, who gave anſwers to certain queries drawn up by Mr Dalrymple concerning the polar ſeas, it appears that he had been in the latitude of 82°.—3. One Mr Watt informed our author, that when he was 17 years of age, at that time making his firſt voyage with Captain M'Callam, a bold and ſkilful navigator, who commanded a Scotch whale-fiſhing ſhip, as during the time that the whales are ſuppoſed to copulate no fiſhing can be carried on, the captain reſolved to employ that interval in attempting to reach the north pole. He accordingly proceeded without the leaſt obſtruction to 83½, when the ſea was not only open to the northward, but they had ſeen no ice for the laſt three degrees; but while he ſtill advanced, the mate complained that the compaſs was not ſteady, and the captain was obliged with reluctance to give over his attempt.—4. Dr Campbell, the continuator of Harris's voyages, informed Mr Barrington, that Dr Dallie, a native of Holland, being in his youth on board a Dutch ſhip of war which at that time was uſually ſent to ſuperintend the Greenland fiſhery, the captain determined, like the Scotchman above mentioned, to make an attempt to reach the pole during the interval between the firſt and ſecond fiſheries. He penetrated, according to the beſt of Dr Campbell's recollection, as far as 88°; when the weather was warm, the ſea free from ice, and rolling like the bay of Biſcay. Dallie now preſſed the captain to proceed: but he anſwered, that he had already gone too far, and ſhould be blamed in Holland for neglecting his ſtation; upon which account he would ſuffer no journal to be kept, but returned as ſoon as poſſible to Spitſbergen.—5. In the year 1662-3, Mr Oldenburg, then ſecretary of the Royal Society, was ordered to regiſter a paper, entitled "Several Inquiries concerning Greenland, anſwered by Mr Gray, who had viſited theſe parts." The 19th of theſe queries is the following: How near hath any one been known to approach the pole?—The anſwer is, "I once met upon the coaſt of Greenland a Hollander that ſwore he had been half a degree from the pole, ſhowing me his journal, which was alſo atteſted by his mate; where they had ſeen no ice or land, but all water."—6. In Captain Wood's account of a voyage in queſt of the north-eaſt paſſage, we have the following account of a Dutch ſhip which reached the latitude of 89°. "Captain Goulden, who had made above 30 voyages to Greenland, did relate to his majeſty, that being at Greenland ſome 20 years before, he was in company with two Hollanders to the eaſtward of Edge's iſland; and that the whales not appearing on the ſhore, the Hollanders were determined to go farther northward; and in a fortnight's time returned, and gave it out that they had ſailed into the latitude 89°, and that they did not meet with any ice, but a free and open ſea, and that there run a very hollow *grown* ſea like that of the Bay of Biſcay. Mr Goulden being not ſatisfied with the bare relation, they produced him four journals out of the two ſhips, which teſtified the ſame, and that they all agreed within four minutes."—7. In the Philoſophical Tranſactions for 1675 we have the following paſſage: "For it is well known to all that ſail northward, that moſt of the northern coaſts are frozen up for many leagues, though in the open ſea it is not ſo, *no nor under the pole itſelf*, unleſs by accident." In which paſſage the having reached the pole